

Say it early.

A teacher who names the problem early, with one fact and one request, is easier to keep. The same skill works with a coordinator and with a parent.

Name _____ Date _____

This is your page for the lesson. The numbers and titles match the lesson on the screen, so you can follow along. Write here, circle here. The answers are in the lesson, not on this page.

Bold on grey is a chunk to learn. Dotted is a word to look up.

1 WARM UP

Where do you stand?

Before you read anything, circle the answer closest to your opinion. There is no right answer.

Most teachers leave because of low pay.

☐ Strongly disagree
 ☐ Disagree
 ☐ Not sure
 ☐ Agree
 ☐ Strongly agree

A teacher who loves the job will not quit.

☐ Strongly disagree
 ☐ Disagree
 ☐ Not sure
 ☐ Agree
 ☐ Strongly agree

A school can keep its teachers without raising salaries.

☐ Strongly disagree
 ☐ Disagree
 ☐ Not sure
 ☐ Agree
 ☐ Strongly agree

Brazilian society respects its teachers.

☐ Strongly disagree
 ☐ Disagree
 ☐ Not sure
 ☐ Agree
 ☐ Strongly agree

How close is your guess?

Two numbers from the OECD teacher survey, TALIS 2024. Write your guess.

What percentage of Brazilian teachers say they are satisfied with their job?

Think about all the teachers you know.

My guess _____ %

What percentage of Brazilian teachers believe the profession is valued by society?

Not by their school. By society.

My guess _____ %

Talk about these first

Then read the article and see who agrees with you.

- 1 Think of a teacher who changed something for you. What did they do?

- 2 What is the hardest part of a teacher's day, in your opinion?

- 3 Is it harder to be a teacher today than twenty years ago? Why?

- 4 A friend who teaches says she is exhausted. What do you say? What do you not say?

- 5 Should a school ask its teachers why they stay, or wait until they resign?

Why are teachers leaving the classroom?

The world needs 44 million more teachers by 2030. Most of those jobs are not new. They are replacements.

By EIC Magazine · 4 min read

In 2024, UNESCO counted how many teachers the world's schools will need by 2030: 44 million more. The surprise is where most of them are needed. About 58% would replace teachers who leave the profession. Only 42% are new jobs.

A leaking bucket

Between 2015 and 2022, attrition among primary teachers almost doubled, from 4.6% to 9%. In half of all countries, primary teachers are paid less than other professions that need similar qualifications. In the United States, a 2025 RAND survey found that teachers worked 49 hours a week on average, ten more than their contracted hours, and 53% reported burnout. That is a heavy workload.

Satisfied, but not valued

Brazil shows another side. In the OECD's TALIS 2024 survey, 87% of Brazilian teachers said they were satisfied with their job, close to the OECD average of 89%. But they lose 21% of class time keeping order (the OECD average is 15%), and only 14% believe teachers are valued by society (the average is 22%).

Pay, workload or respect?

Supporters of higher pay say the numbers are clear: people leave when a job pays less than others with the same training. American teachers earn about \$73,000 on average, while similar workers earn about \$103,000.

Others say the problem is workload and respect. A teacher who loses a fifth of every class to discipline, and who works ten hours beyond the contract, needs support before anything else.

A third group says money is only part of the story. In the United States, the share of teachers who intended to leave fell from 22% to 16% in one year, while the share who said their pay was adequate stayed about the same.

Researcher Ashley Woo warns that "not everyone who says that they are likely to leave is actually going to leave." But on one point, all sides agree: a school learns more by asking teachers before they leave than after.

"Not everyone who says that they are likely to leave is actually going to leave."

Ashley Woo, researcher, quoted by Education Week

44 million

more teachers needed worldwide by 2030 (UNESCO, 2024)

58%

of them would replace teachers who leave

87% / 14%

of Brazilian teachers are satisfied with the job / believe teachers are valued by society (TALIS 2024)

21%

of class time lost to keeping order in Brazil. The OECD average is 15%

Sources: UNESCO, Global Report on Teachers (2024); RAND, State of the American Teacher Survey (2025); OECD, TALIS 2024, released 6 October 2025, as reported by Agência Brasil; Education Week (July 2025).

Comments 7 readers · fictional voices for this lesson

Marina R. · Santos · primary teacher

I love my students, but I take work home every night. On Sundays I plan the whole week. Nobody asked me to, but there is no other time.

Paulo S. · Campinas · secondary teacher

Pay matters. A friend with the same degree left for a job in marketing. Now she earns more and goes home at six.

Dona Cida · Curitiba · retired teacher

Thirty years in the classroom. We were never well paid. What changed is respect. Parents used to back us up. Now some of them back up the child against us.

Helena V. · Belo Horizonte · school coordinator

Last year we started stay interviews. Two teachers told me the same thing: too many extra duties. We took two of them off their plates, and nobody asked for a raise.

Diego L. · replying to Helena · teacher

Nice story, Helena, but I'll believe it when I see it. Taking away duties is good. A raise would be better. Please do not use "no money" as an excuse.

Rafael T. · Recife · parent

I want teachers to be paid more. I also want them to call me early when my son has a problem. I would prefer a hard conversation in March over a surprise in November.

Clara M. · Niterói · education student

Some of my classmates are already looking at other careers. They say they love children, but they do not want to burn out at thirty.

WORDS FROM THE ARTICLE

leave the profession	deixar a profissão
attrition	evasão, saída gradual de profissionais (não é "atrito")
similar qualifications	qualificações semelhantes
contracted hours	carga horária contratada
burnout	esgotamento profissional
workload	carga de trabalho
be satisfied with	estar satisfeito com
keep order	manter a ordem, a disciplina
be valued	ser valorizado
only part of the story	é só parte da história
intend to	pretender, ter a intenção de
adequate	adequado, suficiente
take work home	levar trabalho para casa
back someone up	dar respaldo a alguém
stay interview	entrevista de permanência
extra duties	tarefas extras, atribuições adicionais
raise	aumento de salário
I'll believe it when I see it	só acredito vendo
burn out	esgotar-se, ter burnout

What does the article say?

Facts first, then voices. Every answer is in the text or in the comments.

True or false?

Read the sentence. Is it true, according to the article? If it is false, write the correct fact in the line.

EXAMPLE

"Brazilian teachers lose 21% of class time keeping order."

True

It is true. The text says they lose 21% of class time keeping order. The OECD average is 15%.

- 1 "UNESCO says the world needs 44 million more teachers by 2030."
☐ True ☐ False

- 2 "Most of those teachers would fill new jobs."
☐ True ☐ False

- 3 "Only 14% of Brazilian teachers say they are satisfied with their job."
☐ True ☐ False

- 4 "Attrition among primary teachers almost doubled between 2015 and 2022."
☐ True ☐ False

- 5 "In the United States, the share of teachers who intended to leave grew from 16% to 22%."
☐ True ☐ False

- 6 "In the RAND survey, American teachers worked 49 hours a week on average."
☐ True ☐ False

Find the reader

All the answers are in the comments. Read them again and circle the name.

EXAMPLE

Who has a friend who left teaching for a job in marketing?

Paulo

Paulo says a friend with the same degree left for marketing and now earns more.

- 1 Who says respect has changed more than money?
☐ Marina ☐ Dona Cida ☐ Rafael
- 2 Who found a way to help teachers without a raise?
☐ Helena ☐ Diego ☐ Clara
- 3 Who does not believe the story, and wants a raise?
☐ Paulo ☐ Rafael ☐ Diego
- 4 Who prefers a hard conversation in March to a surprise in November?
☐ Helena ☐ Rafael ☐ Clara

Say it in chunks, not in words

Teachers and coordinators repeat the same phrases. Learn the whole phrase, and the sentence builds itself.

Pick the chunk

Circle the words that complete the sentence. Each answer is a chunk, not a single word.

EXAMPLE

Most teachers say they are _____ with their job.

satisfied

After "be" and "with", use the adjective in -ed: satisfied with.

- 1 She works 49 hours a week, ten hours _____ her contracted hours.
☐ behind ☐ beyond ☐ between
- 2 Many teachers _____ every night, so the day never really ends.
☐ take work home ☐ do work home ☐ make work home
- 3 Brazilian teachers lose 21% of class time _____.
☐ to keep order ☐ for keep order ☐ keeping order
- 4 Only 14% believe that teachers are _____ by society.
☐ valuable ☐ valued ☐ valuing
- 5 A good school wants to _____ its best teachers.
☐ retire ☐ remain ☐ retain
- 6 Is it true that teachers _____ the profession after only a few years?
☐ leave ☐ abandon of ☐ go out of

Write the missing word

Write one word in the space. Use the chunk from the lesson.

EXAMPLE

A school should ask teachers why they stay. This meeting is called a **stay** interview.

A stay interview asks people who are still here. An exit interview asks people who are leaving.

- 1 It is hard to _____ good teachers when the workload is high.
- 2 She is close to _____. She feels empty after every class.
- 3 Eight classes and two extra duties. Is this _____ for a whole year?
- 4 We need to _____ two positions before March. Two teachers left in June.
- 5 Could we look at what can come off my _____? I have too many tasks.

5 LISTEN

The sentence you will say tomorrow

Three short moments from a school. Listen, then choose.

What did you hear?

Your teacher will play each clip. Listen as many times as you like. Then circle the answer.

EXAMPLE

▶ What does the coordinator ask?

How the teacher's week is going

Listen for the question after "says".

- 1 ▶ What does the teacher want?
 - ☐ A higher salary
 - ☐ Fewer extra tasks
 - ☐ A new classroom
- 2 ▶ What does the teacher propose?
 - ☐ A new school
 - ☐ More homework
 - ☐ A homework planner and a second talk
- 3 ▶ What does the teacher do when the answer is no?
 - ☐ She asks for a smaller option
 - ☐ She says she will quit
 - ☐ She stops talking

6 BOSS?

Can you say it to your coordinator?

Read each sentence from the staff room. Circle the blue thumb if you can say it at work. Circle the pink thumb if it is too much.

		I CAN SAY IT AT WORK	TOO MUCH
1	"I'm swamped."		
2	"I'm fried."		
3	"I'm stretched thin across too many classes."		
4	"I'm close to burnout. Could we talk?"		
5	"It's a zoo in there."		
6	"They walk all over me."		
7	"I take work home every night."		
8	"I'm done. I'm out."		
9	"I'm quiet quitting."		

Ask in five moves

Name the problem. Give one fact. Ask for one change, and put a date on it.

1	ASK FOR A MEETING	Could we schedule 20 minutes to talk about my workload? Do not start in the corridor.
2	GIVE ONE FACT	Here is what I'm seeing: I'm regularly working beyond my contracted hours, mostly on marking and planning. One fact first, feeling second.
3	NAME THE EFFECT	It's starting to affect my planning and my energy in class. Say the effect on the students, not only on you.
4	ASK FOR ONE CHANGE	What I'd like to propose is fewer extra duties until the end of term. One request, small enough to say yes to.
5	PUT A DATE ON IT	Could we check in again on the 15th? A date turns a complaint into a plan.

Too blunt, say this

Write a better version on the line. Say it out loud first.

- 1** I can't take this anymore.

- 2** You give us too much work.

- 3** Nobody listens to teachers here.

- 4** I'm thinking of quitting.

- 5** That class is out of control.

With a parent: hard news in three moves

Describe the behaviour, not the child. "He hasn't handed in homework" is something you saw. "He is lazy" is a judgement.

1	SAY WHAT YOU SAW.	"I've noticed that Pedro hasn't handed in his homework for three weeks."
2	ASK WHAT THEY SEE.	"Does that match what you see at home?"
3	AGREE A NEXT STEP, WITH A DATE.	"Could we try a homework planner and talk again in two weeks?"

When the answer is not yet yes

Do not argue. Accept it, ask for something smaller, and put a date on the next talk.

- | | | |
|----------|---|---|
| 1 | ACCEPT IT, THEN ASK FOR SOMETHING SMALLER. | "I understand there is no budget for that. Is there something smaller we could try?"
A concrete answer ("we can cut one duty in March") is a real offer. A vague answer is often a soft no. |
| 2 | ASK TO TALK AGAIN, WITH A DATE. | "Could we revisit this after the mid-year break?" |
| 3 | ASK WHAT WOULD CHANGE THE ANSWER. | "What would you need to see from me to make that possible?" |
| 4 | WHEN THERE IS ANOTHER OFFER, SEPARATE THE TWO. | "That helps, but it doesn't solve the hours. Could we do both?" |
| 5 | WHEN YOU NEED TIME, GIVE A DAY. | "Let me think about it and get back to you by Friday." |

A real exchange

COORDINATOR Is this about the extra classes, or something bigger?

TEACHER Both. I'm happy to cover them, but I'm regularly working beyond my hours. Could we look at what can come off my plate?

COORDINATOR Isn't everyone busy right now?

TEACHER **I hear you.** That's why I'm raising it early, before it affects my classes. Could we check in on the 15th?

When a parent pushes back

PARENT My son is not lazy. I think you just don't like him.

TEACHER **I hear you**, and I'm glad you told me. I want him to do well. Could we look at his last three assignments together and agree on one thing to try this month?

YOUR TURN · COORDINATOR

The coordinator says: "We can't reduce anyone's hours this term." Answer in three moves: accept, ask, date.

YOUR TURN · PARENT

A parent says: "Other kids talk in class too. Why is it always my daughter?" Answer in three moves: say what you saw, ask, agree a next step.

How the school reads it

A coordinator or a head of school does not look at one teacher. She looks at numbers. Here are the numbers and the words she uses.

Satisfied, not valued

■ Brazil
 ■ OECD average

Satisfied with the job



Class time spent keeping order



Believe teachers are valued in society



Say the work is very stressful



All figures in %. OECD, TALIS 2024 (released 6 October 2025), as reported by Agência Brasil.

Numbers you can quote

- **44 million** more teachers are needed worldwide by 2030, and 58% of them would replace teachers who leave. UNESCO, 2024.
- Attrition among primary teachers almost doubled: 4.6% in 2015, 9% in 2022. UNESCO, 2024.
- In half of all countries, primary teachers are paid less than other professions that need similar qualifications. UNESCO, 2024.
- USA, 2025: 53% of teachers report burnout. They work 49 hours a week, ten more than contracted. RAND.

Six terms and the sentence for the meeting

turnover <i>n.</i>	"What is our turnover this year, and who is leaving?"
attrition <i>n.</i>	"Global attrition among primary teachers almost doubled between 2015 and 2022."
retain <i>v.</i>	"How do we retain our best teachers?" "Retention is a pay question and a workload question."
workload <i>n.</i>	"The current workload is not sustainable."
backfill <i>v.</i>	"We need to backfill two positions before March."
onboarding <i>n.</i>	"Onboarding should include a mentor in the first year."

A tool for HR: the stay interview

1	WHAT PULLS THEM IN	What do you look forward to each day when you commute to work?
2	LEARNING	What are you learning here, and what do you want to learn?
3	WHY THEY STAY	Why do you stay here?
4	THINKING OF LEAVING	When is the last time you thought about leaving us, and what prompted it?
5	WHAT YOU CAN DO	What can I do to make your job better for you?

Source: Richard Finnegan, SHRM. Ask every employee the same questions and listen 80%% of the time. A stay interview asks people who are still here. An exit interview asks people who are leaving.

YOUR TURN · STAY INTERVIEW

Choose two of the five questions and ask a colleague. Listen 80% of the time. Then say back what you heard in one sentence.

10 NOW, AGAIN

Did the article move you?

Same four sentences. Circle your answer now. Look back at page 1. Did you move?

Most teachers leave because of low pay.

Strongly disagree

Disagree

Not sure

Agree

Strongly agree

A teacher who loves the job will not quit.

Strongly disagree

Disagree

Not sure

Agree

Strongly agree

A school can keep its teachers without raising salaries.

Strongly disagree

Disagree

Not sure

Agree

Strongly agree

Brazilian society respects its teachers.

Strongly disagree

Disagree

Not sure

Agree

Strongly agree

Facts come from UNESCO, RAND, the OECD (TALIS 2024) and SHRM (stay interview questions by Richard Finnegan). The classroom phrases and sample answers are standard usage written for this lesson. The comments are fictional.